

KATHERYN WRIGHT, Ph.D.

Colchester, Vermont

Email: kwright@champlain.edu Tel: (802) 999-5972

SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

Full Professor and Roger H. Perry Endowed Chair for Innovation at Champlain College; Ph.D. in Interdisciplinary Humanities with specialization in Media Studies and Cultural Geography (Florida State University, 2010). NSF EPSCoR subgrant awardee (\$350K); 20+ publications; author of *The New Heroines* (Praeger, 2016); book in progress *Speculative Education: Making Knowledge from the Ruins*.

Interdisciplinary scholar and academic leader whose work spans digital humanities, posthumanist pedagogy, place-based and experiential learning, interdisciplinary curriculum design, and global education. Founding Program Director of Vermont's first Digital Humanities major; led institution-wide general education redesign serving 1,500+ students across 40+ faculty; conceptualized a modular curriculum framework now adopted college-wide.

Faculty Governance and Global Education with fourteen years of faculty governance experience including search committee leadership, strategic planning, and peer teaching evaluation; currently Chair, Faculty Senate Welfare Committee. Served as Director of Study Abroad, managing two international campuses in Dublin and Montreal with 25+ staff and \$2M budget, growing semester participation 95% within two years.

EDUCATION

Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

Ph.D. in Humanities specializing in Media Studies and Cultural Geography, 2010

- Dissertation: Into the Screenscape: Screens, Bodies, and the Biopolitics of the Population
- Committee: Amit Rai (Chair), Leigh Edwards, Andy Opel, and Kathleen Yancey

M.A. in Humanities specializing in Modern Culture, 2005

Stetson University, DeLand, FL

B.A. in English and Fine Art, 2002

- graduated Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa

CERTIFICATIONS

Champlain College, Burlington, VT

Graduate Certificate in Data Science, anticipated 2027

Undergraduate Certificate in Data Science, 2026

Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

Graduate Certificate in Digital Video Production, 2008

Graduate Certificate in Editing and Publishing, 2006

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

Director of Study Abroad, Champlain College, 2023-2025

- Managed two campus directors with a combined 25+ full-time staff and adjunct faculty across international sites in Dublin and Montreal
- Oversaw \$2 million in operational budgets over three areas, including two budgets managed by direct reports across Burlington, Dublin, and Montreal, managing partnerships, logistics, and strategy for programs serving 150+ students in semester-length programs
- Led post-COVID recovery and program expansion, growing semester participation 95% (92 to 179 students) within two years and launching Dublin summer program
- Directed implementation of modular curriculum's experiential learning component at study abroad sites, launching pilot project-based courses in Fall 2025 serving 38 students

Assistant Dean of Information, Technology, and Sciences, Champlain College, 2025 (sabbatical replacement)

- Oversaw academic operations for 6 programs including course scheduling, faculty teaching assignments, and academic standing determinations
- Supported initiatives and faculty through the transition to the modular curriculum framework, serving as primary administrative liaison for program faculty during a period of significant institutional change

Digital Humanities Program Director, Champlain College, 2023-present

- Serve as founding Program Director for Digital Humanities, redesigning curriculum to align with the modular curriculum framework, advising all majors, and building program visibility through community lectures and podcast on AI ethics and the digital humanities

Global Studies Program Coordinator, 2016-2022

- Advised all students in the Global Studies minor, coordinated curriculum development of global studies coursework with faculty, and co-facilitated two experiential learning travel courses to England/Scotland and The Gambia

Course Coordinator, 2013-2016

- Supported adjunct faculty and onboarding, developed and maintained course guidelines, led the collaborative development of the student-facing digital textbook *Bodies: A Digital Companion* shared across 10+ sections

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2023-present: **NSF EPSCoR subgrant awardee** with Jonathan Banfill and John Levee, “Sonic Experiences of Place in Vermont: Narratives of Changing Land/Soundscapes Over Time” (\$350,000) – *Community-engaged research project documenting sonic experiences of place in Vermont through field recordings, data analysis, and collaborative public programming. Develops place-based digital methodologies connecting acoustic ecology, community knowledge, and digital humanities practice in partnership with the University of Vermont’s Complex Systems Institute.*

2025: **Champlain AI Fellowship** (\$1,000) – Semester-long fellowship examining the intersection of artificial intelligence and pedagogy, funded by the Argosy Foundation.

2016: **CIEE International Faculty Development Seminar Travel Grant** (\$2,000)

2012: **The Peter Rollins Travel Grant for Early-Career Faculty**, Endowment Award from the Popular Culture Association (\$1,000)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Champlain College, Burlington, VT

Roger H. Perry Endowed Chair for Innovation, 2022-present

- In Fall 2025, designed in committee speculative administrative structures to support the institution-wide modular curriculum implementation
- In Spring 2025, delivered campus-wide presentations on the modular curriculum framework to all faculty and staff, facilitating institutional understanding
- From 2023-2024, conceptualized a modular curriculum framework and led development team in crafting an institutional proposal that became the foundation for the college-wide curriculum redesign of all academic programs and general education
- From 2022-2023, created Vermont's first Digital Humanities major program, expanding interdisciplinary course offerings bridging technology and the liberal arts

Professor of Interdisciplinary Studies and Digital Humanities, 2023-present

Associate Professor of Interdisciplinary Studies, 2017-2023

Assistant Professor of Interdisciplinary Studies, 2011-2017

- From 2019-22, led the institution-wide redesign of the general education curriculum, developing 12 new, required interdisciplinary courses that served all 1,500+ students and were taught by 40+ faculty
- Taught 2,100+ students across 95 courses over 15-year tenure at the college

Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

Adjunct Faculty in Interdisciplinary Humanities and Geography, 2010-11

Teaching Assistant (Instructor of Record) in Interdisciplinary Humanities, 2003-2010

- Served as instructor of record, teaching 1,100+ students across 28 courses
- Mentored 10+ graduate teaching assistants through direct classroom observation, pedagogical training, and instructional support

SELECT PUBLICATIONS

Books

Speculative Education: Making Knowledge from the Ruins. (in preparation)

- Develops a theory of knowledge-making under conditions of uncertainty with applications to teaching, curriculum design, academic restructuring, and more broadly, the speculative futures of liberal education
- Introduces the practice of rendering, or working with existing conditions or “ruins” to make new knowledge, alongside the related concepts of the live problem, provisional structures, relational debt, and structural integrity, as a posthumanist approach for reimagining teaching and learning

The New Heroines: Female Embodiment and Technology in 21st Century Popular Culture. Westport: Praeger, 2016.

- Examines the cultural significance of teen and young adult female heroines across popular culture genres and media, tracing a new feminist ideal emerging at the intersection of embodiment, technology, and posthuman subjectivity
- Develops a comparative framework connecting the "New Woman" of the late 19th and early 20th century to contemporary heroines, arguing that connection with people, environment, and technology defines 21st century female embodiment represented by the “New Heroine”

Peer-reviewed Articles and Essays

"Unbecoming the Maker: Rendering and Posthuman Pedagogies in Digital Humanities." (under review)

"A Modular Curriculum for Uncertain Times." *Innovative Higher Education*. (under review)

"Making an Alternate Reality Game." *Critical Digital Humanities Cookbook*. ACRL. (forthcoming)

"Teaching Fake Meat as New Media." *Digest: A Journal of Foodways and Culture*. Vol. 10 No.1/2 (2023): Special Issue: Foodways Pedagogy.

<https://scholarworks.iu.edu/journals/index.php/digest/article/view/38231>

Co-authored with Kristin Novotny. "Re-Making General Education: Envisioning Gen Ed as a Digital Humanities Makerspace." *Impact*, July 2020. 35-40.

<http://sites.bu.edu/impact/previous-issues/impact-summer-2020/>

"The Body Project." *Interdisciplinary Humanities*. Humanities Education and Research Association. Vol. 34, No. 3, 2017. 22-31.

https://www.utep.edu/liberalarts/humanities/_Files/docs/pdfs/HERA-Journal-FALL-2017-3.5.19.pdf

"Haptic Perception Meets Interface Aesthetics: Cultural Representations of Touchscreen Technology in the Aftermath of the iPhone 2007." *Rupkatha Journal on Interdisciplinary Studies in Humanities*. vol. 9, no. 3, September 2017, 1-8. <http://rupkatha.com/v9n302/>

"The Safety Paradox." *Hybrid Pedagogy: A Digital Journal of Learning, Teaching, and Technology*. June 2017. <http://www.digitalpedagogylab.com/hybridped/the-safety-paradox/>

"Reaching for the Screen in Nine Inch Nails' Lights in the Sky." *Refractory: A Journal of Entertainment Media*. Issue 21, December 2012. <https://refractory-journal.com/wright/>

"Violent Entertainment, Popular Culture, and Technological Change: From the Arena to YouTube." *Pop Culture Universe: Icons, Idols, and Ideas*. ABC-CLIO, 2012.

"Urban Screen as Virtual Counterpoint." *Rhizomes: Cultural Studies in Emerging Knowledge*. Issue 17, December 2008. <http://www.rhizomes.net/issue17/wright/index.html>

Book Chapters

Co-authored with Clinton Bryant. "Be Kind, Please Rewind: Video Stores, Algorithmic Recommendation Systems, and the Ethical Commitments of Media Curation." *Media in Transition*. Media Studies Press. (in preparation)

"Wayfinding through Media: The Pop Flâneuse in *Gilmore Girls*." *The Flâneuse in Literature and Culture: Women Wandering Purposefully*. Routledge Research in Women's Literature. (under review)

Co-authored with Emily Hansen. "Trauma, Technology and the Affective Body in *Firefly* and *Dollhouse*." *Blood, Body, and Soul: Essays on Health, Wellness and Disability in Buffy, Angel, Firefly, and Dollhouse*. Eds. Tamy Burnett and AmiJo Comeford. McFarland, 2022.

"Pop Culture Pilgrimage and the Politics of Place: An Autoethnography of Kunta Kinteh Island." *Dark Tourism and Pilgrimage*. Eds. Daniel Olsen and Maximiliano Korstanje. Oxfordshire: CABI, 2020.

"*Gilmore Girls*: 'Bon Voyage.'" *Television Finales: From Howdy Doody to Girls*. Eds. Douglas Howard and David Bianculli. Syracuse: Syracuse UP, 2018.

Co-authored with Clinton Bryant. "*How I Met Your Mother*: 'Last Forever.'" *Television Finales: From Howdy Doody to Girls*. Eds. Douglas Howard and David Bianculli. Syracuse: Syracuse UP, 2018.

Co-authored with Michael Kelly and Michael Lange. "The Problems and Possibilities of Integrating Professionalism and Education: A Case Study of the Senior Capstone Experience at Champlain College." *Perspectives in Interdisciplinarity and Integrative Studies*. Eds. Patrick C. Hughes, Juan S. Munoz, and Marcus N. Tanner. Texas Tech University Press, 2015.

"Revolutionary Art in the Age of Reality TV." *Of Bread, Blood, and The Hunger Games: Critical Essays on the Suzanne Collins Trilogy*. Eds. Mary Pharr and Leisa Clark. Jefferson: McFarland Press, 2012.

"Nine Inch Nails' *Year Zero* and the Biopolitics of Media Convergence." *The Politics of Post-9/11 Music: Sound, Trauma, and the Music Industry in the Time of Terror*. Eds. Joseph P. Fisher and Brian Flota. Farnum: Ashgate, 2011.

"Total Immersion and the Total Screen: The Simulated and Screened Realities of Video Games." *Simulation in Media and Culture: Believing the Hype*. Ed. Robin DeRosa. Lanham: Lexington, 2011.

SELECT PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks and Public Scholarship

"Cyborgs, Culture and AI Literacy with Dr. Katheryn Wright." *ExpAIInED*, episode 5, Amazon Music. 4 April 2025.

"Me, You, and AI." Lamoille Valley Osher Lifelong Learning Institute. Stowe Cinema 3Plex: Stowe, VT. 19 March 2025.

"Building Interdisciplinarity." Lecture and workshop. Purdue University Northwest: Hammond, IN. 13 November 2024.

"AI: Our Newest Digital Companion." Vermont Humanities Council: Snapshot Series. Burnham Memorial Library: Colchester, VT. 23 October 2024.

<https://www.vermonthumanities.org/event/ai-our-newest-digital-companion/>

"Notes Toward a Speculative Education: Design, Theory, Practice." Mellon Cultural Studies Lecture Series. Johnson C. Smith University: Charlotte, North Carolina. 10 March 2022.

"Walk Like a Posthuman." Reckless Ideas Lecture Series - Generator Makerspace in collaboration with UVM Complex Systems Center. Burlington, Vermont. 20 November 2019.

Panelist, "Where Are We Now?" Johnson C. Smith University Faculty Summer Institute for Technology and New Media. Johnson C. Smith University: Charlotte, North Carolina. 6 June 2016.

Plenary Lecture, "Second Screens and Critical, Digital Pedagogies." Johnson C. Smith University Faculty Summer Institute for Technology and New Media. Johnson C. Smith University: Charlotte, North Carolina. 5 June 2014.

Conference Papers, 2010 - present

"DH-ing Gen Ed: Re-Imagining Liberal and General Education through the Digital Humanities." Association for General and Liberal Studies Annual Conference. Orlando. 20 September 2019.

"Girl Power or Potential? Teen Heroines, Gender, and Giftedness in Popular Culture." Popular Culture Association National Conference. New Orleans. April 2015.

"Two Screens Are Better Than One: Physical Violence, Haptic Technology, and Connected Viewing through AMC's Story Sync." Cultural Studies Association (CSA) Conference. University of Utah, Salt Lake City. 30 May 2014.

"Violence on the Second Screen: A Case Study of AMC's Story Sync." Northeast Popular Culture Association (NEPCA) Conference. St. Michael's College. 26 October 2013.

"The Second Screen Experience." Communication and Digital Culture I: Mobile Masses, Mobile Media. Popular Culture Association National Conference. Washington Marriott Wardman Park, Washington DC. 29 March 2013.

"Connecting through Screens." Aesthetics and Politics in Television Studies. Flow Conference. University of Texas at Austin. 3 November 2012.

"Tactility and the Aesthetics of the Interface." New and Emerging Theories of Visual Culture. Popular Culture Association National Conference. Copley Marriott Hotel, Boston. 12 April 2012.

"Touch Screen Technology and the Cultural Politics of Framing in Contemporary Visual Culture." Media Textures: Haptical Themes Onscreen and Off. Society for Cinema and Media Studies Annual Conference. Boston Park Plaza Hotel and Towers, Boston. 22 March 2012.

"Negotiating the Possibilities and Limitations of Navigable Space in Contemporary American Cinema." Navigating Cinematic Space. Society for Cinema and Media Studies Annual Conference. Ritz Carlton Hotel, New Orleans. 10 March 2011.

"River's Gift: The Production of the Affective Body in *Firefly* and *Serenity*." Firefly and Serenity 1. The Slayage Conference on the Whedonverses 4. Flagler College, St. Augustine. 4 June 2010.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Courses Taught at Champlain College, 2011-present

Digital Humanities, AI, and Emerging Technology – Introduction to Digital Humanities; First Year Inquiry: Making Alternate Reality Games; Field Methods: Sonic Data Worlds; Media Psychology

Global and Place-based Learning – Global Studies Senior Seminar; The Global Condition; Global Studies I: Technology and Development; Local Contexts, Global Connections: Afrofuturism; Connecting Place and Identity; Field Methods: Printmaking in Public

Interdisciplinary Approaches and Critical Theory – Interdisciplinary Perspectives: Escape Rooms and Collaborative Design; Interdisciplinary Perspectives: Fake Meat and the Future of Food; Bodies, with focus sections on The Posthuman, Walking, Touch/Haptics; Heroines and Heroes, with focus sections on Feminist Theory, The New Heroines; Theoretical Perspectives: Posthumanism Goes to the Movies; Core Sandbox: Interdisciplinary Workshop; Scientific Revolutions; Concepts of the Self; Aesthetic Expressions

Professional and Applied Learning – Psychology Senior Capstone; Game Development Senior Capstone; Creative Media Senior Capstone; Information, Technology, and Sciences Senior Capstone

Courses Taught at Florida State University, 2003-2011

Media Studies and Humanities – New Media in Theory and Practice; Television and Culture; Modern Humanities; Medieval, Renaissance, Baroque Humanities; Multicultural Film and American Culture; Communications Geography

AWARDS AND HONORS

2024: Academic Innovation Award - Steering Committee for College-wide Curricular Redesign

2023: Academic Innovation Award - Re/Imaging Science Team for Curriculum Development

2020: Faculty Fellowship "Posthumanism and Food" - Emergent Media Center, Champlain College

2010: Dissertation Defense, Florida State University - High Pass

2006: David Darst Award for Excellence in Teaching in the Humanities, Florida State University

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Service at Champlain College, 2011-present

2026-present: Chair, Faculty Senate Welfare Committee

2025: Administrative Restructuring Sub-Committee

2023-present: Committee Member, Champlain College Montreal Board of Trustees

2023-2024: Steering Committee - Applied Humanities

2021-2022: Lead Faculty, Digital Humanities Program Development

2021: Steering Committee, Experiential Learning Institute

2019-2022: Director, Core Curriculum Revision

2019-2020: Chair, Search Committee in the Core Division

2016-2017: MakerLab Initiative Taskforce

2016-2018: Academic Affairs Committee

2012-14: Chair, Faculty Senate Committee for Professional Development

2012-13: Faculty Priority Projects Implementation Team appointed by the Provost

Service to the Profession

2026-present: New England Commission of Higher Education, Evaluator Pool

2025-present: External Reviewer, Palgrave Macmillan

2025: External Reviewer, Interdisciplinary Studies Program, Johnson C. Smith University

2016: Peer Reviewer, Computers in Human Behavior

2015-2021: Editorial Board, Hybrid Pedagogy

2007-09: Managing Editor, InterCulture: An Interdisciplinary Journal

2005-07: Director and Founding Member, Association for Interdisciplinary Research

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Digital Humanities Summer Institute (DHSI), Victoria, BC and Montreal, QC

- “Convivial AI” (2026)
- “Programming Pedagogy in the Age of AI” (2025)
- “Palpability and Wearable Computing” (2019)
- “Feminist Digital Humanities” (2017)

“Data Visualization and Communication.” UVM Professional and Continuing Education, University of Vermont. 2023.

“Consuming Istanbul: Politics of Space and Spectacle.” CIEE Faculty Seminar, Istanbul, Turkey. January 2016.